

44 Union Square East

The House That Wore Democracy

Every borrowed phrase is highlighted and colour-coded by source; a dashed underline marks one adapted rather than quoted word for word. Where the source page is on file, clicking the highlight opens the scan.

COLOUR KEY — ONE COLOUR PER SOURCE · sources with a page scan are marked [↗](#)

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| ■ Sackersdorff, <i>1815 Blue Book</i> , 1815 p. 4 (1) ↗ | ■ Perris, <i>1853 Perris Maps</i> , 1853 p. 52 (2) ↗ |
| ■ Robinson, <i>1885 Robinsons Atlas</i> , 1885 p. 15 (1) ↗ | ■ Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Five</i> , 1926 p. 2035 (1) ↗ |
| ■ Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003 p. 250 (11) ↗ | ■ Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932 p. 23 (6) ↗ |
| ■ Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016 p. 679 (12) ↗ | ■ Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i> , 1996 p. 78 (5) ↗ |
| ■ LPC, <i>Union Square</i> , 1929 p. 1 (1) ↗ | ■ Hennessy, <i>Walking Broadway</i> , 2020 p. 95 (2) ↗ |
| ■ Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010 p. 1278 (7) ↗ | ■ Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995 p. 1 (5) ↗ |
| ■ Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003 p. 64 (5) ↗ | ■ Holmes, <i>100 New Yorker</i> , 2004 p. 37 (1) ↗ |
| ■ Wilson, <i>New York in Literature</i> , 1947 p. 128 (2) ↗ | ■ Reynolds, <i>Monuments and Masterpieces</i> , 1988 p. 187 (4) ↗ |
| ■ Awaiting source (4) | |

■ **Dashed underline** — adapted from the source it is coloured for (trimmed, re-cased or paraphrased), not word-for-word. (21)

^v verbatim · ^A adapted · ^o the poet's own — every phrase in the text carries its provenance.

AUDIO — 44 UNION SQUARE | BRICK CAKE POEM 4 min 10 s

Audio track — playable in the HTML version of this document.

I. THE GROUND

Before the brick^o, before the name^o the ground held only quiet claim^o— (reference to 0 structures,)^v bare^o, a page of Union Place^o laid there^o.

Then dwellings rose,^o (first class)^v in stone^o, with (skylights)^v of their very own^o; a hotel took the corner next^o— the (West Moreland,)^A on the deed embossed^o— and where the (Clarendon Hotel)^v once stood^o the future gathered, dark and good^o.

II. THE SOCIETY

A brotherhood^o, *(an outgrowth of the patriotic Sons of Liberty)*^v, they called themselves^o *(The Society of St. Tammany or Columbian Order,)*^v free^o; they took *(a sachem of the Delaware)*^A for their sign^o, one^o *(of the chiefs of the Algonquins)*^v down the line^o, who^o *(held undisputed sway over Eastern America)*^A of old^o.

Then came the^o *(Boss)*^v—the infamous^o *(William Tweed)*^v—whose fall^o would let a^o *(New Tammany)*^v proceed^o.

III. THE BUILDING

They hired the hands of^o *(Thompson, Holmes & Converse)*^v and^o *(Charles B. Meyers)*^v to reverse^o a shabby name^o with *(a dignified architectural treatment,)*^v *(severe Colonial columns)*^v for embellishment^o, of *(red Harvard brick)*^v and^o *(terra cotta and limestone)*^A, *(specially molded and oversized brick laid in Flemish bond,)*^v alone^o, with *(double-height pilasters,)*^v a^o *(rusticated stone base,)*^A and up above, *(Hipped Roof Changing to Shell Dome)*^v in place^o.

A *(striking resemblance)*^A they would cast^o to *(Federal Hall)*^v and Washington's past^o—the very ground^o where^o *(George Washington took the oath of office)*^A—a mask of marble for a house of graft^o.

IV. THE REPUTATION

They wore the mask to hide the stain^o of *(graft, corruption, and misused power)*^v—the old refrain^o; and yet the coffers^o gave: to^o *(Japan's earthquake sufferers,)*^v the^o *(Cuban Freedom Fund,)*^v the^o *(Irish Bond Issue,)*^v its offerers^o claimed grace—*(revered... feared... hated)*^A all at once^o, *(so eulogized or so condemned)*^v for months^o, now^o *(a byword for municipal)*^A shame^o, and yet they built it just the same^o.

V. THE FALL

(Tammany reached its zenith)^A in its hour^o—then^o *(Seabury)*^v came to test the tower^o; *(Walker was forced to resign)*^A and go^o, and^o *(La Guardia)*^v led the^o *(coalition)*^A blow^o that held^o *(for 12 years)*^A its ground^o; the fortunes fell;^o *(unable to meet)*^A the pound^o of mortgage, the^o *(sachems sold their building)*^A down^o.

VI. THE AFTERLIVES

To (Local 91)^v of the^o (International Ladies Garment Workers Union)^v it passed^o, a hall of labor^o, needle-work and mast^o; the^o (Roosevelt Auditorium)^v rang^o till (Roundabout)^v came in and sang^o— then^o (moved to 45th Street)^A and away^o, and^o (Vanessa Redgrave)^v took the stage one day^o, with^o (Glenn Close)^v, (John Turturro)^v, a benefit for the shelled^o— the^o (children of Sarajevo)^v held^o.

And^o (the New York Film Academy)^v bright^o, would^o (Learn Film Making)^v in the light^o, (Carpe Diem)^v carved above the door^o where bosses schemed and schemed before^o.

VII. THE SQUARE

Outside,^o the Square was never tame^o— (anarchists, socialists, Wobblies, and Communists)^v made their claim^o, a^o (workers protest of 35,000)^A massed^o, and^o Nellie Bly^o lectured on her^o (record-breaking trip around the globe)^v at last^o.

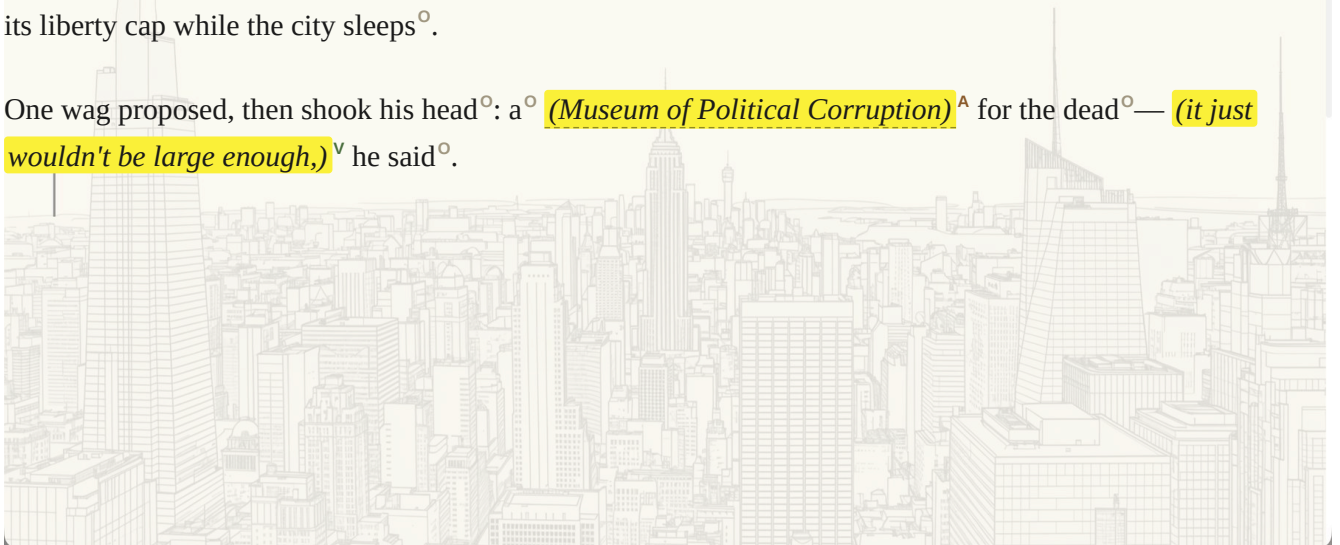
And here^o (the last home of Jeannette L. Gilder)^A was set^o, the^o (editor of the Critic)^A we forget^o.

VIII. THE REMNANT

A^o (phantom)^v in the^o (crawl space)^v stayed^o, till (the sounds stopped)^v and the racket^o frayed^o; above the Square^o, (a liberty cap)^A (eminently visible)^v on the map^o, across from where the^o (Charles F. Murphy Monument)^v stands near^o the^o (Independence Flagstaff)^v, year on year^o.

The^o (sole physical remnant)^v of it here^o— (shabby as it is,)^v and dear^o, a^o (big part of our past)^v it keeps^o, its liberty cap while the city sleeps^o.

One wag proposed, then shook his head^o: a^o (Museum of Political Corruption)^A for the dead^o— (it just wouldn't be large enough,)^v he said^o.



CITATION CHART

Every highlighted quote, in order of appearance, correlated to its underlying source. The swatch matches the highlight colour in the text.

I. The Ground

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
1	"reference to 0 structures,"	 Sackersdorff, <i>1815 Blue Book</i> , 1815, p. 4 [page scan]
2	"first class"	 Perris, <i>1853 Perris Maps</i> , 1853, p. 52 [page scan]
3	"skylights"	 Perris, <i>1853 Perris Maps</i> , 1853, p. 52 [page scan]
4	"West Moreland,"	 Robinson, <i>1885 Robinsons Atlas</i> , 1885, p. 15 [page scan]
5	"Clarendon Hotel"	 Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Five</i> , 1926, p. 2035 [page scan]

II. The Society

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
6	"an outgrowth of the patriotic Sons of Liberty"	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
7	"The Society of St. Tammany or Columbian Order,"	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
8	"a sachem of the Delaware"	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
9	"of the chiefs of the Algonquins"	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
10	"held undisputed sway over Eastern America"	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
11	"Boss"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
12	"William Tweed"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
13	"New Tammany"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]

III. The Building

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
14	"Thompson, Holmes & Converse"	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
15	"Charles B. Meyers"	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
16	"a dignified architectural treatment,"	 Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i> , 1996, p. 78 [page scan]
17	"severe Colonial columns"	 Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i> , 1996, p. 78 [page scan]
18	"red Harvard brick"	 Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i> , 1996, p. 78 [page scan]
19	"terra cotta and limestone"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
20	"specially molded and oversized brick laid in Flemish bond"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
21	"double-height pilasters,"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
22	"rusticated stone base,"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
23	"Hipped Roof Changing to Shell Dome"	 LPC, <i>Union Square</i> , 1929, p. 1 [page scan]
24	"striking resemblance"	 Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i> , 1996, p. 78 [page scan]
25	"Federal Hall"	 Hennessy, <i>Walking Broadway</i> , 2020, p. 95 [page scan]
26	"George Washington took the oath of office"	 Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i> , 1996, p. 78 [page scan]

IV. The Reputation

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
27	"graft, corruption, and misused power"	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
28	"Japan's earthquake sufferers,"	 — awaiting source —
29	"Cuban Freedom Fund,"	 — awaiting source —
30	"Irish Bond Issue,"	 — awaiting source —
31	"revered... feared... hated"	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
32	"so eulogized or so condemned"	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
33	"a byword for municipal"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]

V. The Fall

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
34	"Tammany reached its zenith"	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
35	"Seabury"	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
36	"Walker was forced to resign"	 Hennessy, <i>Walking Broadway</i> , 2020, p. 95 [page scan]
37	"La Guardia"	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
38	"coalition"	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
39	"for 12 years"	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
40	"unable to meet"	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
41	"sachems sold their building"	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]

VI. The Afterlives

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
42	"Local 91"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
43	"International Ladies Garment Workers Union"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
44	"Roosevelt Auditorium"	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
45	"Roundabout"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
46	"moved to 45th Street"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
47	"Vanessa Redgrave"	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
48	"Glenn Close"	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
49	"John Turturro"	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
50	"children of Sarajevo"	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
51	"the New York Film Academy,"	Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
52	"Learn Film Making"	Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st</i> 1995, 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
53	"Carpe Diem"	— awaiting source —

VII. The Square

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
54	"anarchists, socialists, Wobblies, and Communists"	Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
55	"workers protest of 35,000"	Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
56	"record-breaking trip around the globe"	Holmes, <i>100 New Yorker</i> , 2004, p. 37 [page scan]
57	"the last home of Jeannette L. Gilder"	Wilson, <i>New York in Literature</i> , 1947, p. 128 [page scan]
58	"editor of the Critic"	Wilson, <i>New York in Literature</i> , 1947, p. 128 [page scan]

VIII. The Remnant

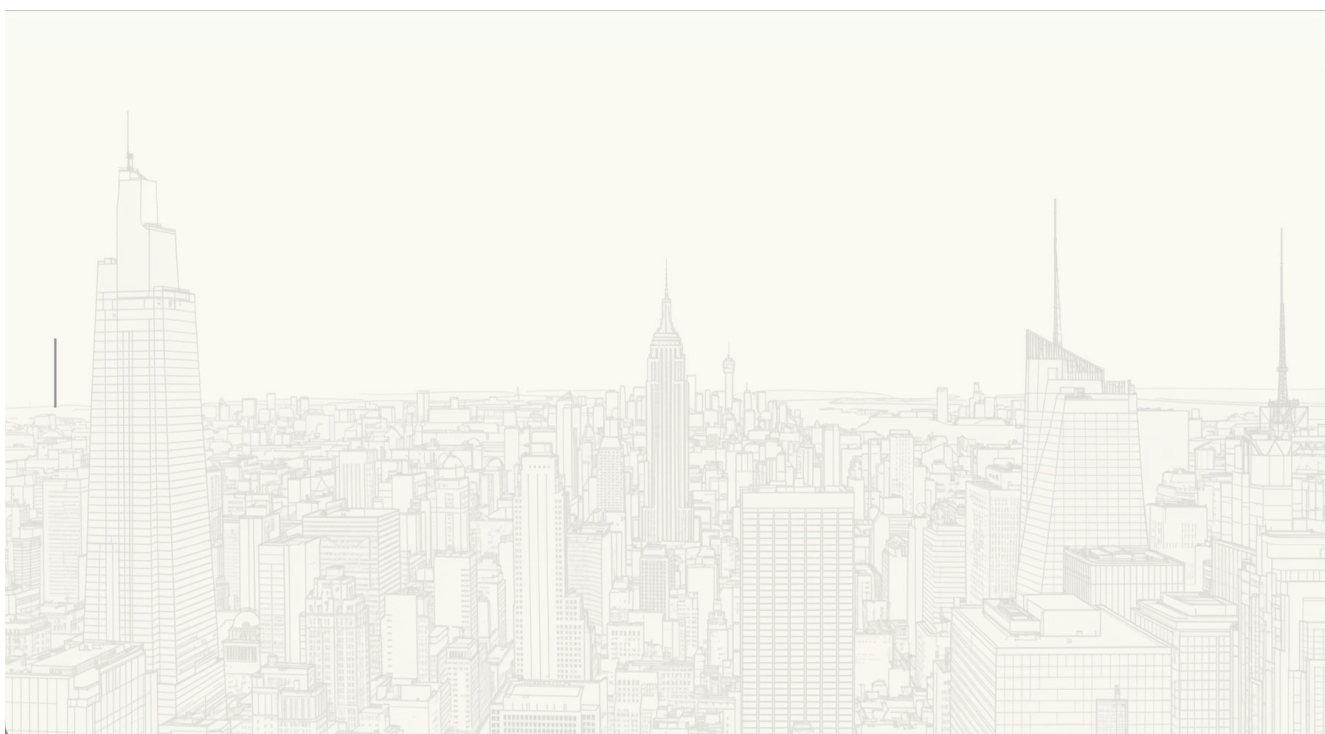
#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
59	"phantom"	Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
60	"crawl space"	Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
61	"the sounds stopped"	Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
62	"a liberty cap"	Reynolds, <i>Monuments and Masterpieces</i> , 1988, p. 187 [page scan]
63	"eminently visible"	Reynolds, <i>Monuments and Masterpieces</i> , 1988, p. 187 [page scan]
64	"Charles F. Murphy Monument"	Reynolds, <i>Monuments and Masterpieces</i> , 1988, p. 187 [page scan]
65	"Independence Flagstaff"	Reynolds, <i>Monuments and Masterpieces</i> , 1988, p. 187 [page scan]
66	"sole physical remnant"	Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
67	"shabby as it is,"	Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
68	"big part of our past"	Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
69	"Museum of Political Corruption"	Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
70	"it just wouldn't be large enough,"	Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]



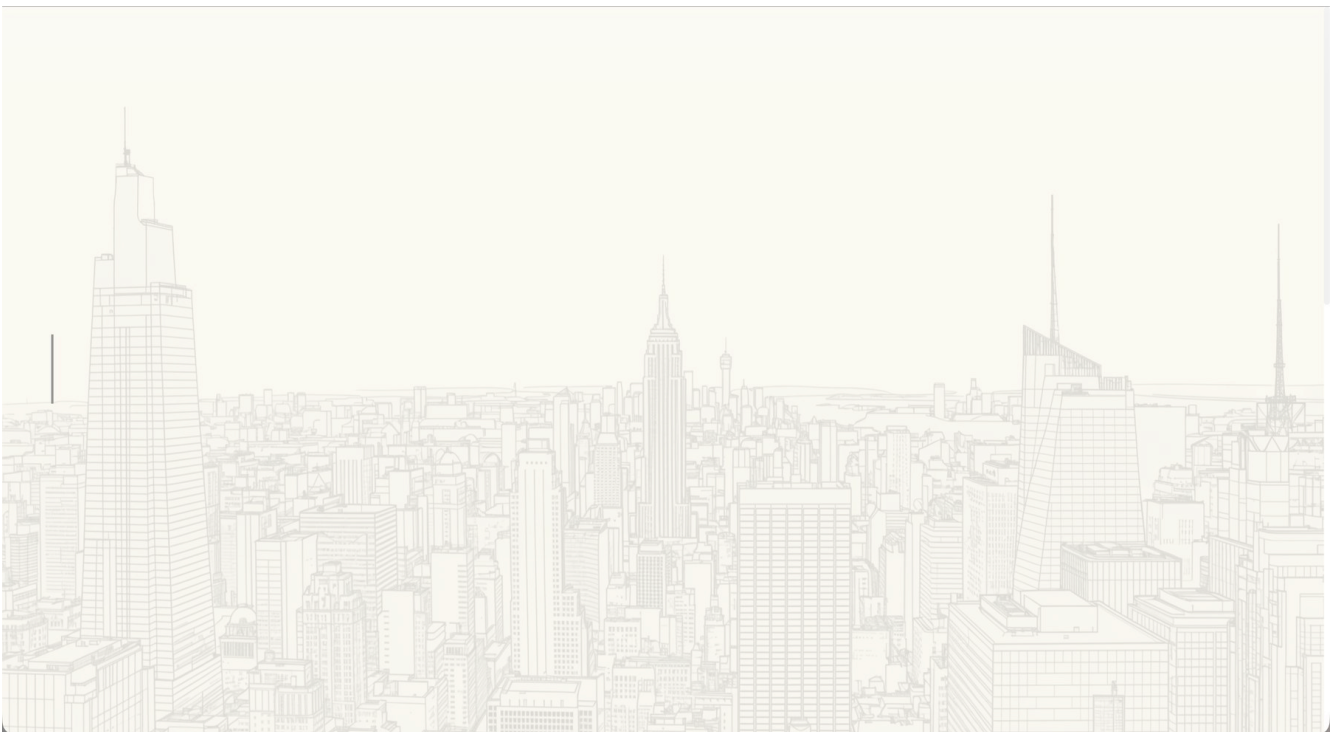
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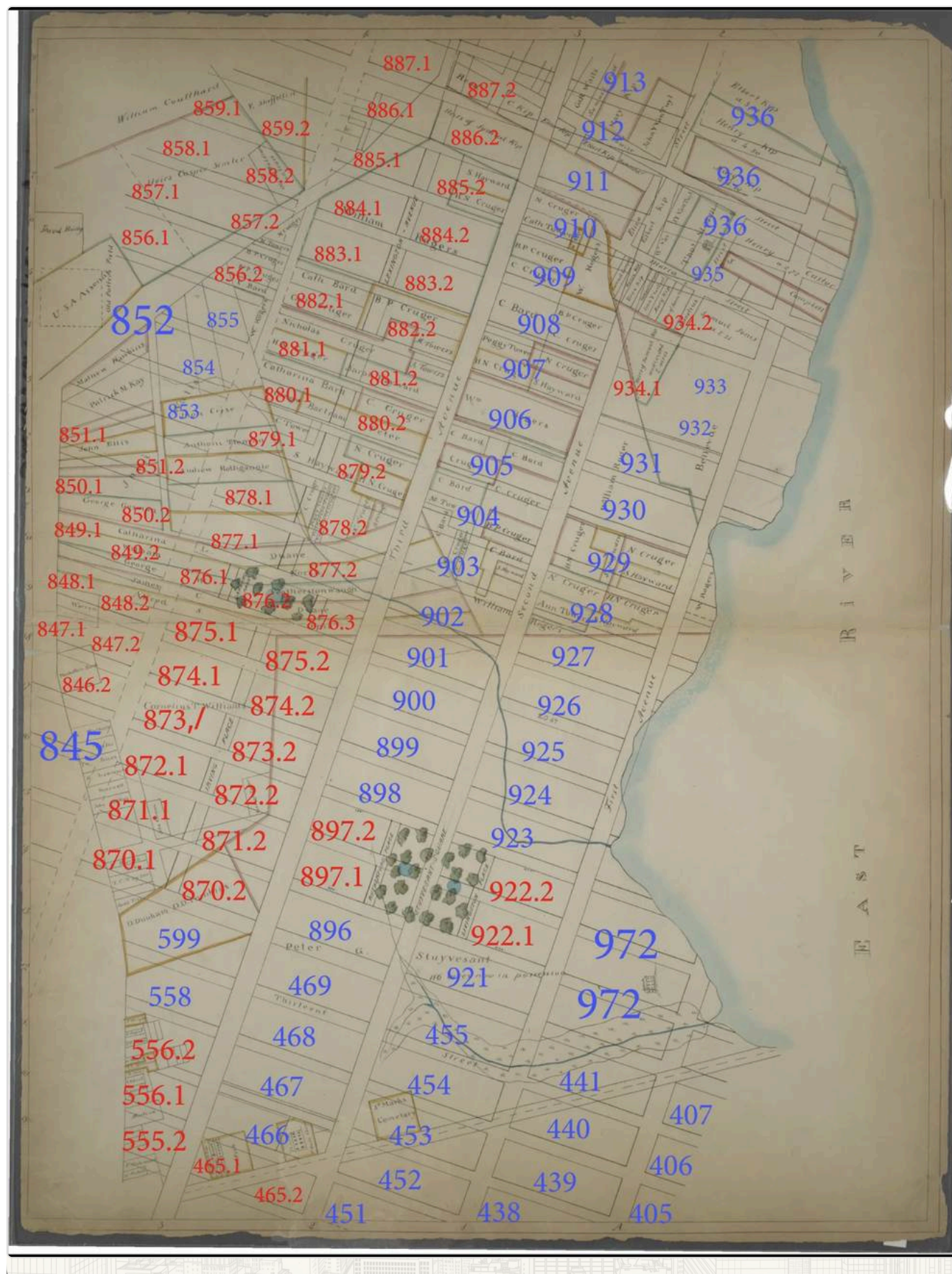
16 scanned pages, one per cited source page. Each lists the highlighted quotes drawn from it.



Sackersdorff, 1815 *Blue Book*, 1815, p. 4

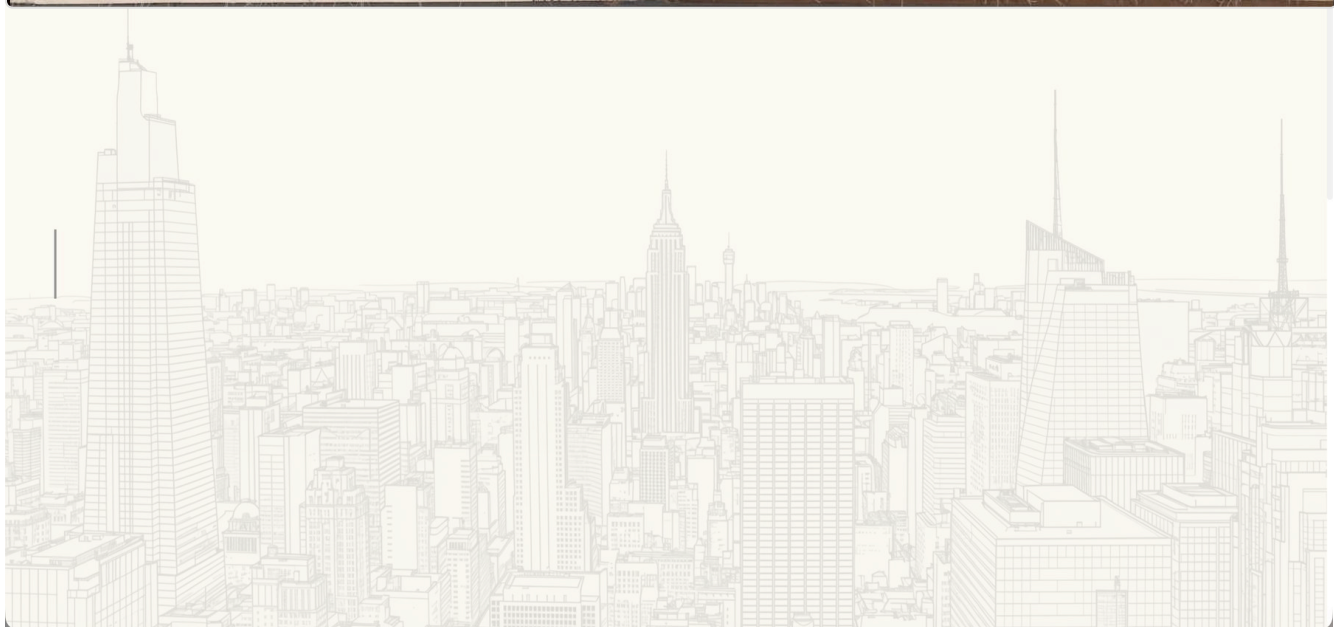
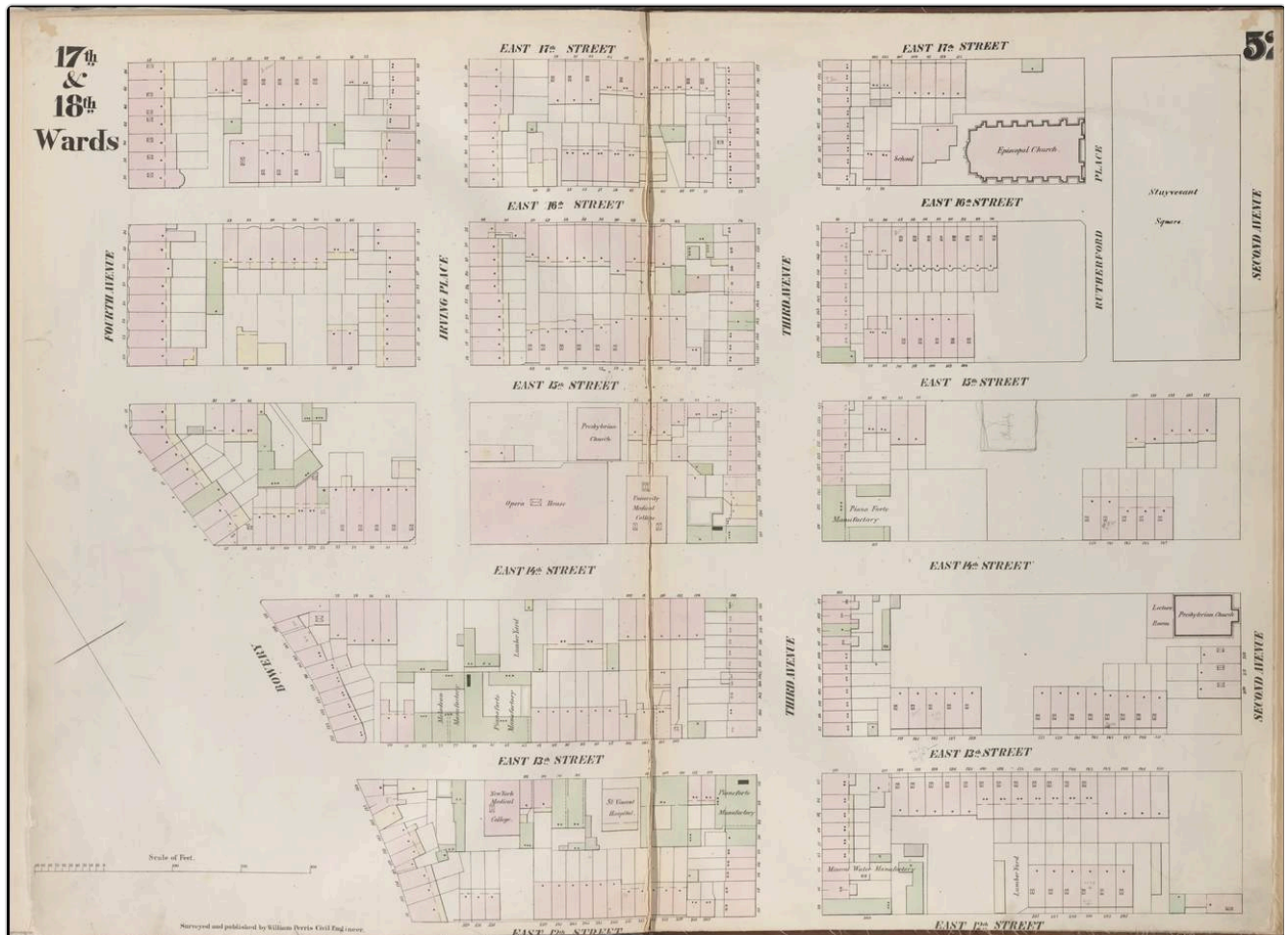
Quotes drawn from this page: 1





Perris, 1853 Perris Maps, 1853, p. 52

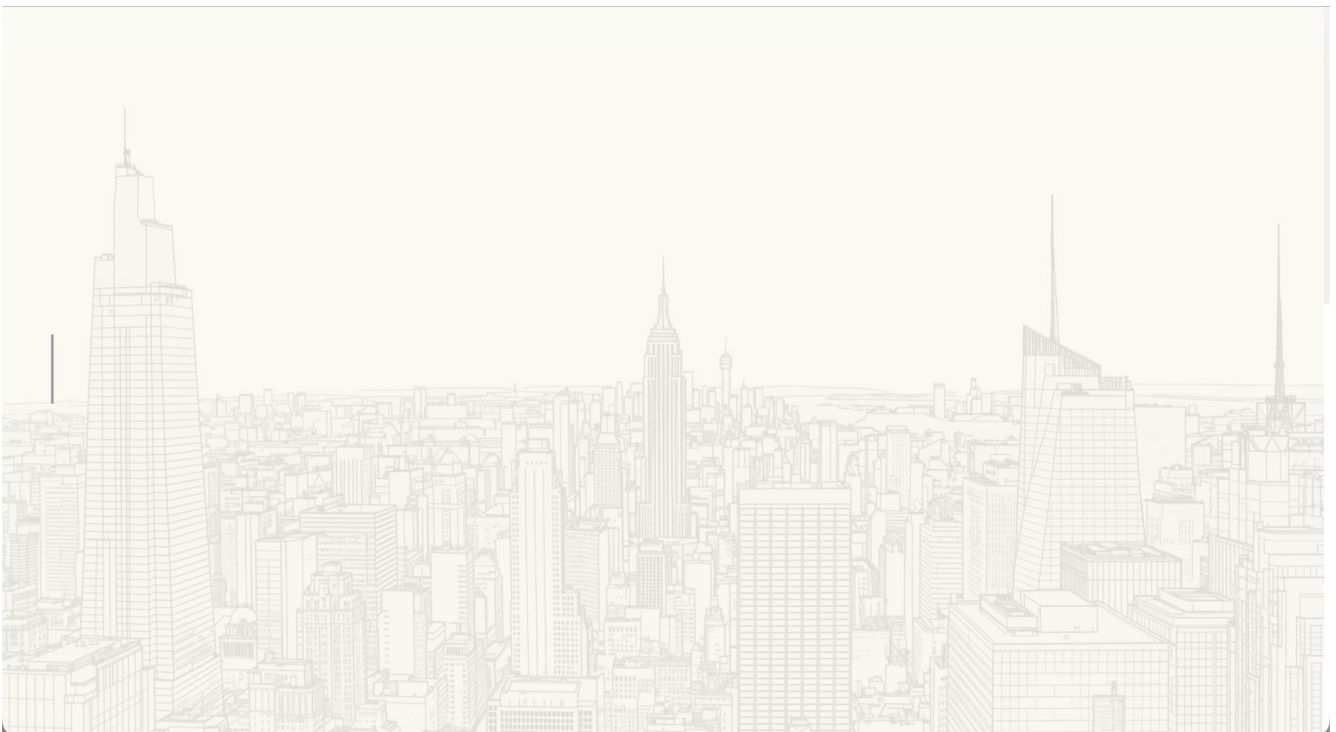
Quotes drawn from this page: 2 3



Quotes drawn from this page: 4

Stokes, *The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Five*, 1926, p. 2035

Quotes drawn from this page: 5



CHRONOLOGY : THE MODERN CITY AND ISLAND : 1876-1909 2035

- 1898 The Spanish fleet under Admiral Cervera attempts to escape July from Santiago Harbour and is totally destroyed by Admiral Sampson's American squadron.—*N. Y. Times*, JI 4 et seq., 1898.
- " Harlem Speedway (see Mr 8, 1893, and N 2, 1896) is formally opened, though not completed. It extends from 155th St. and St. Nicholas Place to the easterly extremity of Dyckman St. along the west bank of the Harlem River. Its total cost was about \$3,050,000.—*Ann. Rep.*, Dept. of Pks. (1898); *ibid.* (1900). See also *N. Y. Times*, F 15 and Jc 26, 1898.
- 7 Pres. McKinley signs the congressional resolution annexing Hawaii to the United States.—*N. Y. Times*, JI 8, 1898.
- 14 Gen. Toral agrees to surrender Santiago to the American forces under Gen. Shafter.—*N. Y. Times*, JI 15, 1898. The formal surrender took place on July 17.—*Ibid.*, JI 17, 18 et seq., 1898.
- 20 Horse-cars cease running on Sixth and Eighth Aves. below 59th St. and the work of constructing the electric lines is begun.—*N. Y. Times*, JI 18 and 21, 1898. See N 16.
- Aug. 1 The new iron bridge across the Harlem River at Third Ave. is completed at a cost of more than \$3,000,000, and is opened to the public.—*N. Y. Times*, Ag 2, 1898; *Ann. Cyclop.* (1898), 506. See also *N. Y. Times*, F 11, 1893, and *Harper's Weekly*, XXXVIII: 115.
- 12 A peace protocol is signed at Washington by representatives of Spain and the United States, and Pres. McKinley immediately proclaims a suspension of hostilities.—*N. Y. Times*, Ag 13, 1898.
- 13 Ignorant of the armistice, Americans under Dewey capture Manila.—*N. Y. Times*, Ag 16 et seq., 1898.
- 20 Admiral Sampson's victorious squadron arrives at New York and is given an ovation.—*N. Y. Times*, Ag 21, 1898.
- Sept. 8 Weber & Fields' Broadway Music Hall at 1215 Broadway is opened.—*N. Y. Times*, S 9, 1898.
- Oct. 2 Automobiles "have almost ceased to be regarded as curiosities, and the embarrassment of the passengers caused by many staring eyes, is gradually wearing off."—*N. Y. Times*, O 2, 1898. See D 28.
- 3 "Cyranos de Bergerac" is produced for the first time in America, at the Garden Theatre. Richard Mansfield plays the title role. Sullivan, *Our Times* (1926), I: 224; *Brown, III*: 528. 872.1
- 14 The Clarendon Hotel, at the south-east corner of 17th St. and Fourth Ave., has been closed.—*N. Y. Times*, O 14, 1898.
- Nov. 8 Theodore Roosevelt is elected governor of New York State.—*N. Y. Times*, N 9, 1898. 1285.2
- 12 Columbia University's land and buildings on East 49th St. (once the site of the Deaf and Dumb Asylum) have been sold, and dwelling-houses are to be erected on the site.—*N. Y. Times*, N 12, 16, D 19, 1898.
- 16 The Third Ave. R. R. Co. begins to tear up Broadway from 45th to 59th St. preparatory to laying the conduits for the electrical system.—*N. Y. Times*, N 17, 1898.
- 21 Piner's "Trelawny of the Wells" is produced for the first time in America, at the Lyceum Theatre.—*Brown, III*: 438. See also Sullivan, *Our Times* (1926), I: 230. 1187.1
- 25 Construction work on the section of Riverside Park between 120th and 129th Sts. being approved, this part is practically completed, except planting. A small part near 96th St. is left unfinished on account of a change in the original plan due to building the viaduct over that street.—*Ann. Rep.*, Dept. of Parks (1898), 18. Regarding the park, see also *Munsey's Mag.*, Oct., 1898.
- Dec. 4 A fire, starting at the corner of Broadway and Warren St., destroys about a million's worth of property.—*N. Y. Times*, D 5, 1898.
- 10 The treaty of peace between Spain and the U. S. is signed at Paris. Spain relinquishes all claim to Cuba and cedes to the U. S. Porto Rico, Guam, and the Philippine Islands, and the U. S. agrees to pay \$20,000,000 for the ceded territory.—Macdonald, *Select Statutes of U. S. Hist.*, 1861-1898, 429-36; *N. Y. Times*, D 11, 1898.
- 28 "Horseless trucks will soon be seen in the streets of this city, and before long there may be no opportunities for usefulness left for the hard-working truck horse. The autotruck is to be the latest innovation in street traffic. The New York Autotruck Company has been incorporated with a capital of \$1,000,000 to operate the vehicles."—*N. Y. Times*, D 28, 1898.

1899

- In this year, *The Rough Riders*, by Theodore Roosevelt, appeared.—*Encyclop. Brit.*, XXIII: 711. Commenting on it, Mr. Dooley (Finley Peter Dunne) said, with characteristic humour:

"If I was him I'd call th' book 'Alone in Cuba.' " He suggested 1899 as other titles: "Th' Biography iv a Hero be Wan who Knows;" "Th' Darin' Exploits iv a Brave Man be an Actual Eye-Witness, th' Account iv th' Destruction iv Spanish Power in th' Ant Hills, as it fell fr'm th' lips iv Teddy Rosenfelt an' was took down be his own hands."—Sullivan, *Our Times* (1926), I: 206.

In this year, the corruption in New York City became almost as bad as in 1894 (q. v., Ja 31), when the Lexow investigation was held, and the legislature again determined to investigate, and for this purpose sent to the city a committee, which was generally known as the "Mazet Committee." Gustavus Myers thus describes its work and the results: "This body's prestige suffered from the charge that its investigation was unduly partizan. Moreover, it was generally felt by the public that its work was inefficiently carried on. Nevertheless, it produced a considerable array of facts showing the existence of gross maladministration."

"It was disclosed that every member of the Tammany Society or of the organization's executive committee, held office, or was a favored contractor. Over \$700,000 of city orders went to favored contractors without bidding. Various city departments were 'characterized by unparalleled ignorance and unfairness.' The payrolls in some of the most important departments had increased \$1,500,000 between July 1, 1898, and September 1, 1899, and the employees had increased over 1,000, excluding policemen, firemen and teachers. The testimony proved the increasing inefficiency and demoralization of the Police and Fire Departments. It further proved the existence of a ramified system of corruption similar to that revealed by the Lexow Committee."

"The disclosures attracting the greatest public attention were those relating to the Ice Trust, the Ramapo project, and Mr. Croker's relations to the city government. On April 14 the Committee exposed a conspiracy between the Ice Trust and the Dock and other departments of the city government, to create and maintain a monopoly of New York's ice supply. Six days after the exposure, Mayor Van Wyck, as he subsequently admitted in his testimony before Judge Gaynor, acquired 5,000 shares, worth \$500,000, of the Ice Truck stock, alleging that he paid \$57,000 in cash for them; but although urged to substantiate his statement, did not produce proof that he actually paid anything. It was shown conclusively before the committee that the arrangement between the Ice Trust and the city officials was such as to compel the people to pay 60 cents a hundred pounds, and that the trust had stopped the sale of five-cent pieces of ice, practically cutting off the supply of the poor. Many other Tammany officials were equally involved. Proceedings were begun some time after, looking to an official investigation of the Ice Trust's affairs, and charges against Mayor Van Wyck were filed with Gov. Roosevelt. The latter were finally dismissed by the Governor in November, 1900.

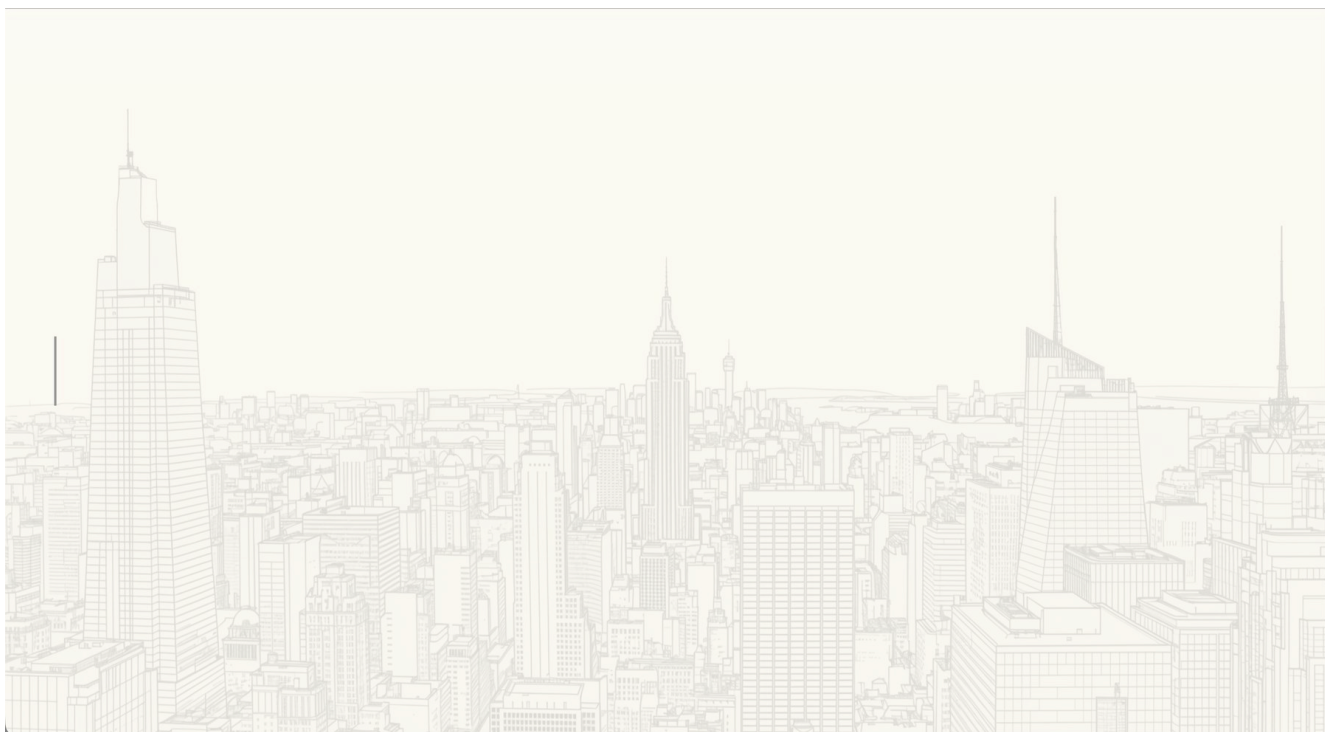
"In August, the committee uncovered the Ramapo scheme. The Ramapo Water Company, with assets 'of at least the value of \$5,000,' sought to foist upon the city a contract calling for payment from the city treasury of an enormous amount in annual installments of about \$5,110,000, in return for at least 200,000,000 gallons of water a day, at \$70 per million gallons. This was proved to be an attempt toward a most gigantic swindle. Had not Controller Coler exposed and frustrated the scheme, the Tammany members of the Board of Public Improvement would have rushed the contract to passage.

"Mr. Croker's testimony threw a flood of light upon his political views and standards as well as his powers and emoluments as 'boss.' He acknowledged that he had a powerful influence over the Tammany legislators at Albany, whose actions he advised, and that he exercised the same influence upon local officials. He readily conceded that he was the most powerful man he knew of. . . .

"Mr. Croker also admitted that judicial candidates were assessed in their districts. In fact, some of the Judges themselves named the respective sums to the committee. Judge Pryor testified that he had been asked for \$10,000 for his nomination for a vacant half-term in the Supreme Court. Other judicial candidates, it was understood, paid from \$10,000 to \$25,000 for nominations. Mr. Croker maintained that the organization was entitled to all the judicial, executive, administrative—in brief, all offices—because 'that is what the people voted our ticket for.' Mr. Croker refused to answer many questions tending to show that he profited by a silent partnership in many companies which benefited directly or indirectly by his power. . . . He declined to answer the

Wolfe, *New York 15 Walking Tours*, 2003, p. 250

Quotes drawn from this page: 6 7 14 15 44 51 66 67 68 69 70



familiar sight in the city. With the departure of the insurance company, the building was converted into a hotel (Rockwell Group, 2001). Alas, the old sign is gone (despite a public outcry), replaced by the hotel's own. Interestingly, the former name of Guardian was the Germania Life Insurance Company, but anti-German sentiment during World War I resulted in a reshuffling of the letters of Germania to Guardian. The aluminum and glass annex to the east was designed in 1961 by Skidmore, Owings & Merrill.

Around the corner, the trim neo-Federal-style brick-and-limestone building, No. 100 East 17th Street (Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, 1929), was the "final resting place" of **Tammany Hall**, the Democratic political machine that held the city in a corrupt stranglehold for almost two centuries. The club was founded in 1788 as an outgrowth of the patriotic Sons of Liberty and called The Society of St. Tammany or Columbian Order. According to local preservationist Jack Taylor, "the building is such a great example of Colonial Revival, of a time when a group tried to burnish its crooked reputation by linking itself to early American ideals," adding, "the history of Tammany Hall, shabby as it is, is also a big part of our past, and this building is the sole physical remnant of that." While awaiting the city's decision on landmark designation, it was suggested that the Tammany Hall building be converted into a "Museum of Political Corruption"; however, one wag observed that "it just wouldn't be large enough!"

By 1943, unable to meet its mortgage payments, Tammany sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies Garment Workers Union. In 2001, they, in turn, sold it to Liberty Theaters, who remodeled the union's former meeting hall—once called the Roosevelt Auditorium—into the present **Union Square Theater**. The building is also home to the **New York Film Academy**, a noted school for filmmakers.

At East 15th Street, look above the ground floor of No. 24–33 at the dingy cast-iron façade of the **former S. Klein-on-the-Square Department Store**. Klein's first opened on the Square in 1910, but by 1921 relocated to a rambling emporium that grew northward from 14th to 16th streets. For years, its huge distinctive neon "On the Square" sign atop the complex was a familiar city landmark. Klein's was a pioneer in discount merchandising, and its frequent sales would always attract hordes of bargain hunters. By 1975, however, competition from other discount stores and its distance from the city's new shopping centers, plus old-fashioned merchandising techniques and a rather decrepit interior, hastened its demise. The southwest corner of Klein's 15th Street building was earlier the site of the posh **Union Square Hotel**, a favorite with the Theater District celebrities of the Gilded Age.

At the northeast corner is the **former Union Square Savings Bank**, now the **Daryl Roth Theatre**, No. 20 Union Square East (Henry Bacon, 1905). Like a vestige of ancient Greece, the white granite-front structure boasts a façade of bold Corinthian columns, in a style favored by architect Bacon, whose major work is the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. The bank closed in 1992, but the ven-

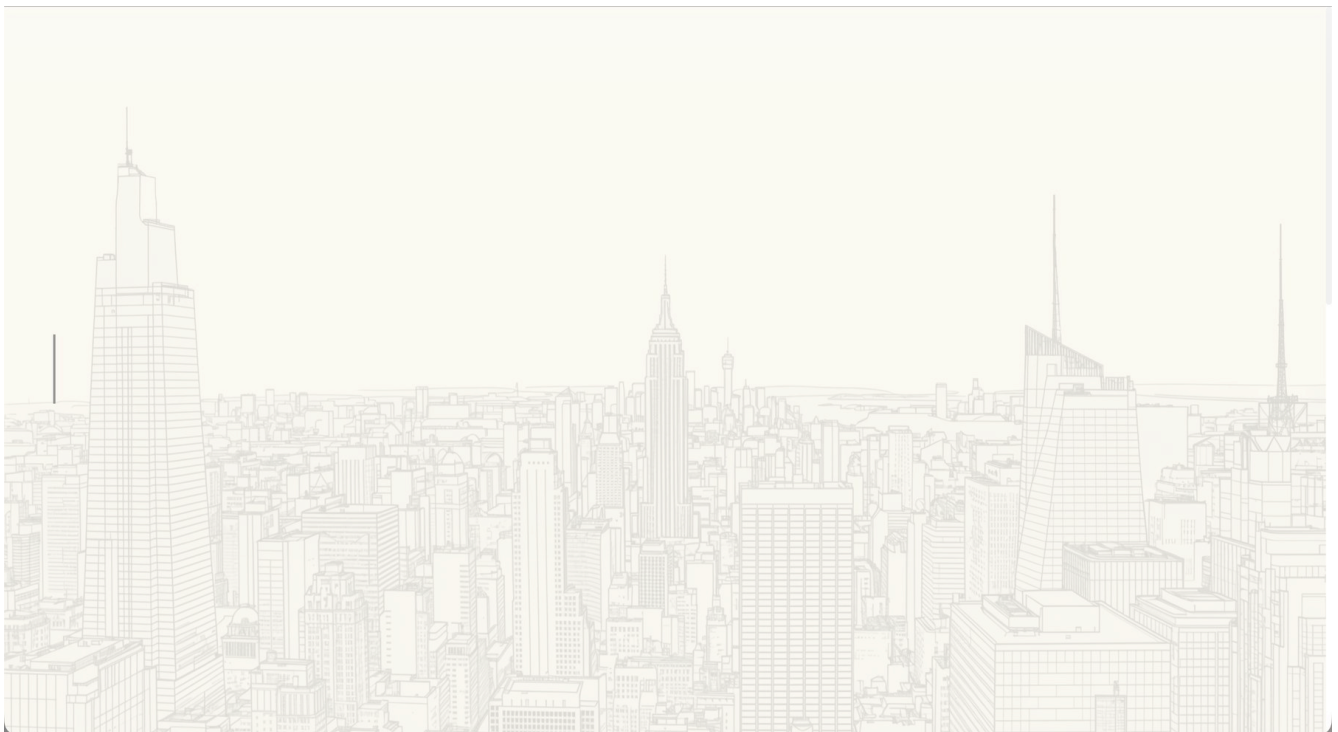
the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. The bank closed in 1972, but the venerable building is now enjoying a new life, with the former banking hall remodeled and converted for novel and unconventional theatrical productions.

Walk into the park to the **bronze Statue of Lafayette**, by famed French sculptor Frédéric Auguste Bartholdi (1876). While collecting funds for his later Statue

845.1

Chase, New York *The Wonder City*, 1932, p. 23

Quotes drawn from this page: 8 9 10 27 31 32



TAMMANY HALL

AND

POLITICS IN NEW YORK

TAMMANY HALL!!—revered by its constituents; feared by neutrals; hated by its opponents!

The New York Tammany Society was founded about 1786, and organized under a constitution in 1789 as a charitable and patriotic order. It has gradually developed into one of the most powerful political influences in the history of our nation.

Deriving its name from a sachem of the Delaware Indians (Tammany—one of the chiefs of the Algonquins, living on the banks of the Delaware River, who for years held undisputed sway over Eastern America) this great society, from its very organization became a dominating factor in the councils of the Democratic Party and has commanded such a power in local, state, and even national politics, that the name "Tammany" has become known world over.



JOHN R. VOORHIS
102 Years of Age,
Born in July, 1829.
Elected Grand Sachem
of Tammany for 20th
term on May, 1931.

Tammany Hall is the shrine at which hundreds of thousands of loyal democrats worship, and point with pride to its achievements. On the other hand, its opponents damn Tammany Hall as the hellish headquarters for graft, corruption, and misused power!

Has any institution ever organized outside of fanatical religious circles, been so beloved or so hated; so lauded or so execrated; so eulogized or so condemned!

At the time this is written, a new legislative investigation of New York City's administration has Tammany under fire on charges of various misdeeds. But it would be premature to forecast the outcome. It will not be denied, however, that Tammany's history reveals the names of many of America's most prominent and respected sons, who are or have been enrolled as members.

Records also show that vast sums have been donated to charity or expended in relieving distress—not only in New York and America, but all over the world, such as generous contributions to Japan's earthquake sufferers, the Cuban Freedom Fund, the Irish Bond Issue, the Messina earthquake disaster, etc. Those who can see no good in Tammany insist that Tammany is an agency of Satan and that policy prompts these benefactions. They claim that all this is merely a part for a price paid for votes and popularity.

Therefore, any estimate of Tammany to be formed by a stranger, must be based largely on whether information or data concerning the institution is furnished by a Tammany supporter, or a Tammany opponent.

New York politics are so intimately identified with Tammany Hall it is said that the Democratic Party in New York City is so completely controlled by this powerful organization that no nominee has even a fighting chance for victory unless endorsed by Tammany.



In State politics, also, Tammany commands an influence which is widespread and generally conceded to be a power that must be thoroughly recognized.

23

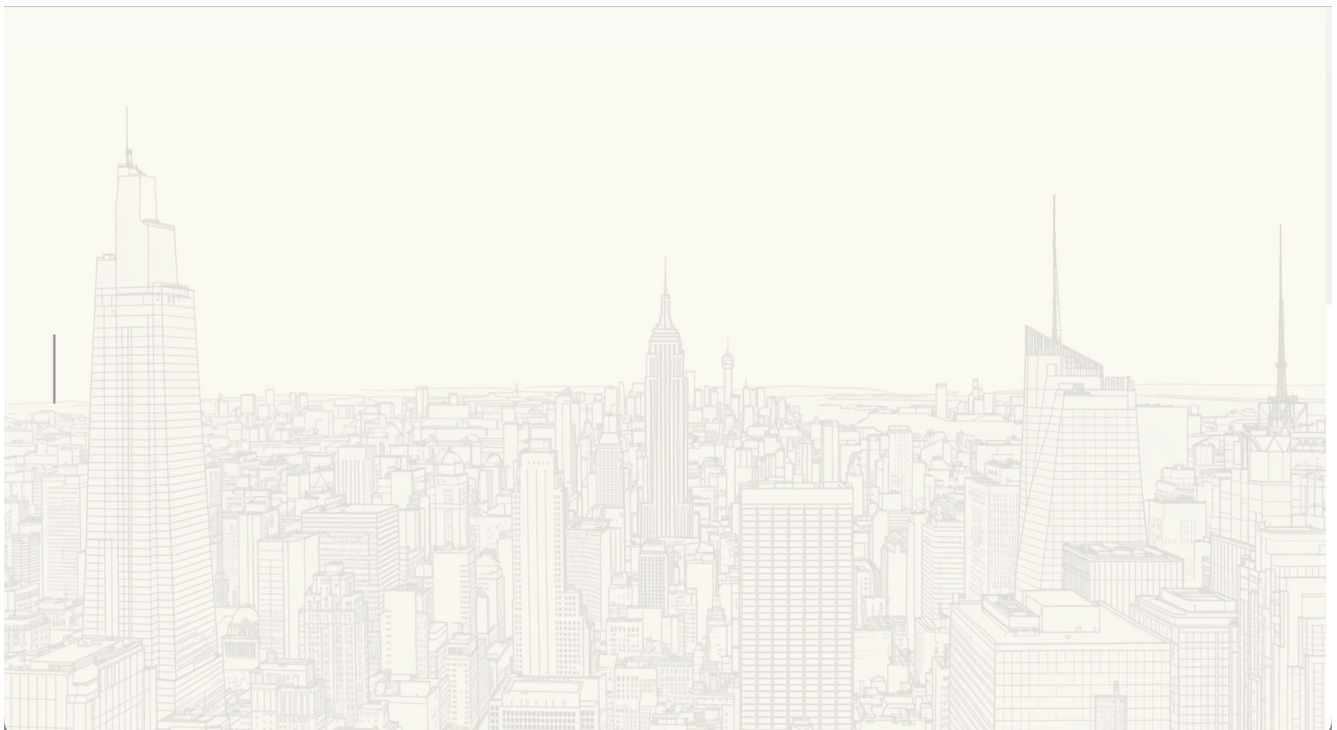


The new Tammany Hall, facing Union Square at 17th Street and 4th Avenue. Built in 1929.

872.1

Spielvogel, *The Landmarks of New York*, 2016, p. 679

Quotes drawn from this page: 11 12 13 19 20 21 22 33 42 43 45 46





NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY

**NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY, FORMERLY
ROUNABOUT THEATRE; LOCAL 91 OF
ILGWU; TAMMANY HALL**

1928–29; 1943; 1984; 1991; 1994;
2001; 2005

100 EAST 17TH STREET, (AKA 100–102
EAST 17TH STREET, 44–48 UNION
SQUARE, 44–48 UNION SQUARE EAST),
MANHATTAN.

ARCHITECTS: THOMPSON, HOLMES &
CONVERSE AND CHARLES B. MEYERS

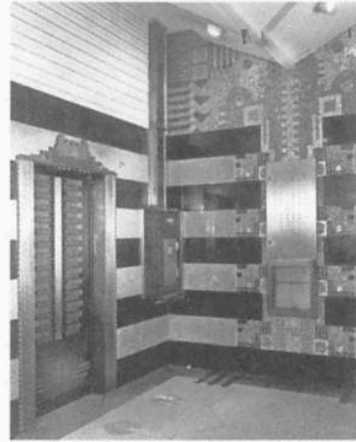
DESIGNATED: OCTOBER 29, 2013

Tammany Hall, now a byword for municipal corruption, once dominated the City's political arena. An outgrowth of the eighteenth-century Tammany Society, Tammany Hall quickly became affiliated with the newly formed Democratic Party, promoting public education, universal suffrage for white males, and helping to abolish debtors' prisons; as well as providing support for newly arrived Irish, French, and German immigrants. By the mid-nineteenth century, Tammany was firmly in charge of the municipal government, and under the leadership of the now infamous "Boss" William Tweed. His fall, and the emergence of a "New Tammany" in the

1920s, refashioned as a "good government" organization, has been identified by some as the impetus for the construction of this New Tammany Hall, the only surviving headquarters building of Tammany.

This distinguished neo-Georgian façade, with its rusticated stone base, double-height pilasters, and sculptural reliefs in terra cotta and limestone, was inspired by the original Federal Hall (demolished 1812) on Wall Street, where the first President of the United States, George Washington, took his oath of office. Clad with specially molded and oversized brick laid in Flemish bond, other neo-Georgian elements of the façade, such as the blind arches that frame the multilight sash windows, the fanlight transoms, wrought iron balconies, and semicircular attic window, deliberately evoke the dignity of early American architecture.

In 1929, when the building was completed, Tammany had again fallen out of favor, and by 1943, the Society sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies Garment Workers Union, which occupied it until 1984. That year, the Local entered into a lease agreement with the Roundabout Theatre, which renovated and occupied the building's auditorium until 1991, when it moved to 45th Street. Local 91 subsequently leased the auditorium to producer Raymond L. Gaspard, and then to the owners of Minetta Lane Theatre. In 1994, the Local began leasing portions of the building not occupied by the theater to the New York Film Academy; in 2001, the entire building was sold to Liberty Theatres



FILM CENTER BUILDING INTERIOR

and four years later the air rights were conveyed to US Development LLC.

FILM CENTER BUILDING INTERIOR

1928–29

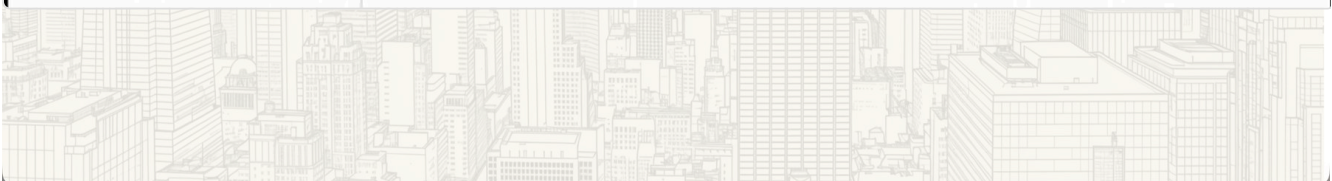
630 NINTH AVENUE, MANHATTAN

ARCHITECT: ELY JACQUES KAHN

DESIGNATED: NOVEMBER 9, 1982

The Film Center Building's interiors are among the most colorful and inventive surviving Art Deco ensembles in New York City. Walls and ceilings are treated as woven plaster tapestries, a motif frequently employed by architect Ely Jacques Kahn. He may have been influenced by Frank Lloyd Wright's California textile block houses, which were built in the mid-1920s; both architects shared an interest in Mayan architecture, which seems evident in their work.

In the outer vestibule, an ornamental plaster band runs across the ceiling and



Dolkart, *Gramercy*, 1996, p. 78

Quotes drawn from this page: 16 17 18 24 26





NOS. 100-102 EAST 17TH STREET
Former Tammany Hall

On the southeast corner of East 17th Street and Union Square East, at 100-102 East 17th Street, stands the second of the district's institutional buildings, **Tammany Hall**, once the headquarters of New York City's Democratic Party political machine. Late in 1927, the Society of Tammany sold its headquarters on East 14th Street and announced the construction of a new Tammany Hall. Plans for the new building were made public in January 1928.⁵⁰ The building, designed by Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, was to be a Colonial Revival structure built of red Harvard brick with granite trim (limestone was later substituted). The *Real Estate Record* described the design as "a dignified architectural treatment, one of the chief motifs of which are the severe Colonial columns in the centers of the Union Square and the Seventeenth-street facades which recall the days of early American architecture."⁵¹

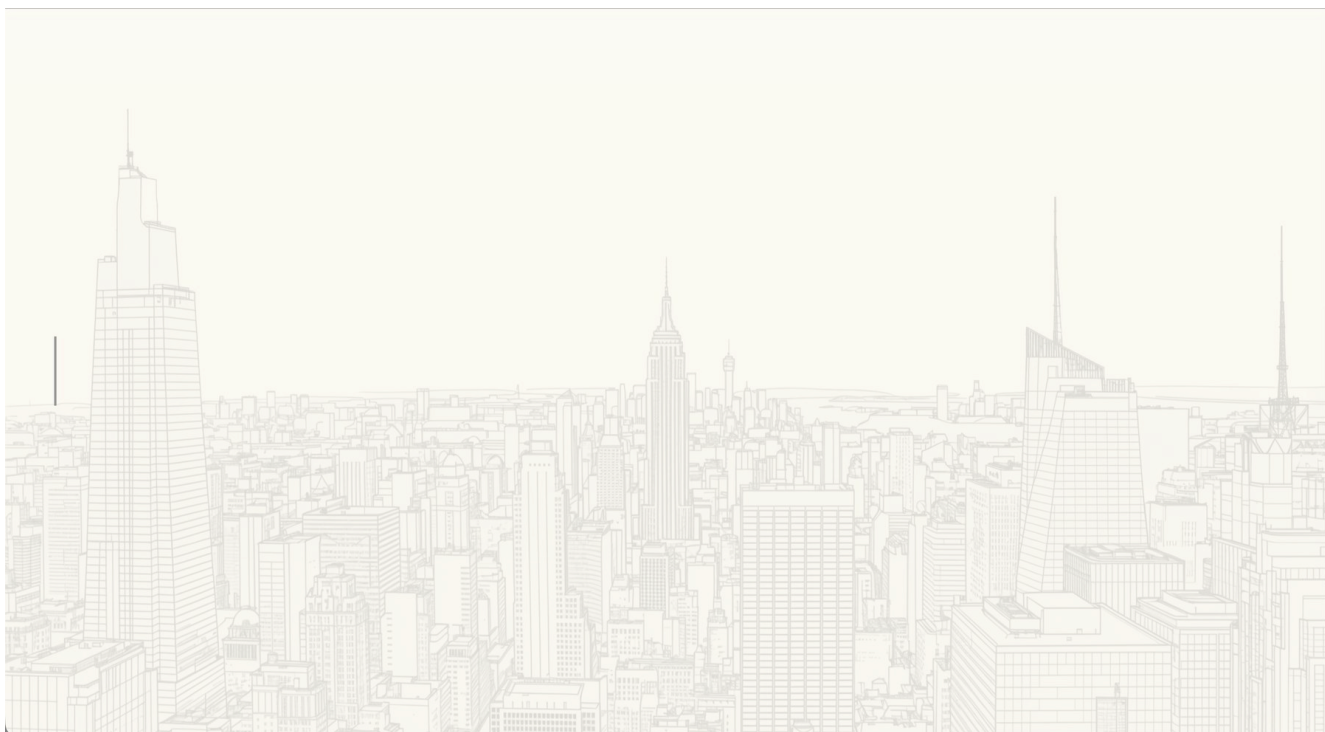
The Colonial Revival was undoubtedly chosen not only because it was reminiscent of the architecture of the early republic, but also because it symbolized the government established during that period. The Society of Tammany was attempting to associate itself with the ideals of early American democracy; in fact, the Union Square facade bears a striking resemblance to the original Federal Hall, where George Washington took the oath of office as the first President of the United States. By choosing the Colonial Revival style, with all that it symbolized, Tammany may have been attempting to create the image of a truly democratic force to counter the accusations that it was a corrupt political machine.

50. "Architects Picked for Tammany Hall," *New York Times*, January 18, 1928, p. 52; "New Tammany Hall Will Be Colonial in Design," *Real Estate Record and Builders Guide* 121 (January 28, 1928), p. 7. The *Real Estate Record* article includes an elevation drawing. A slightly different elevation drawing, closer to the building as actually constructed, was illustrated in the Architectural League's *Yearbook* (1929), n.p.

51. "New Tammany Hall..."

LPC, *Union Square*, 1929, p. 1

Quotes drawn from this page: 23

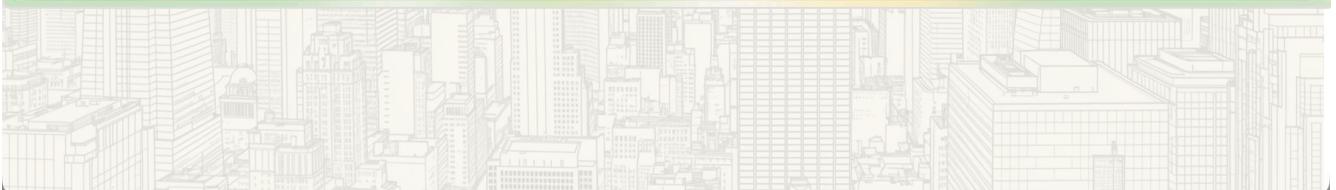


"<Architecture Style>_neo-Georgian, Contemporary,
<Base Material>_Rusticated Limestone, <Façade
Material>_Clinker Brick, Limestone, Terra Cotta,
<Entrance Description>_Molded Arched Surround,
Gothic Arched Transom, <Window Detail>_2nd fl.
Balcony, Flat Arch Brick Lintels, Stone Keystones,
Projecting Sills, Window Panes: [8/8], Window Panes:
[12/12], <Brickwork Style>_Doric Pilasters, Doric
Columns, Pedimented Portico, Double Height Pilasters,
Stone Console Brackets, Quoins, Sculptural Relief Tablet,
Rondels, <Roofline Description>_Doric Entablature,
Garlands, Roundel, Balustrade, Hipped Roof, Brick/
Stone Parapet, Construction: Hipped Roof Changing to
Shell Dome."

LPC · (1929) UNION SQUARE · 1929 · P. 1

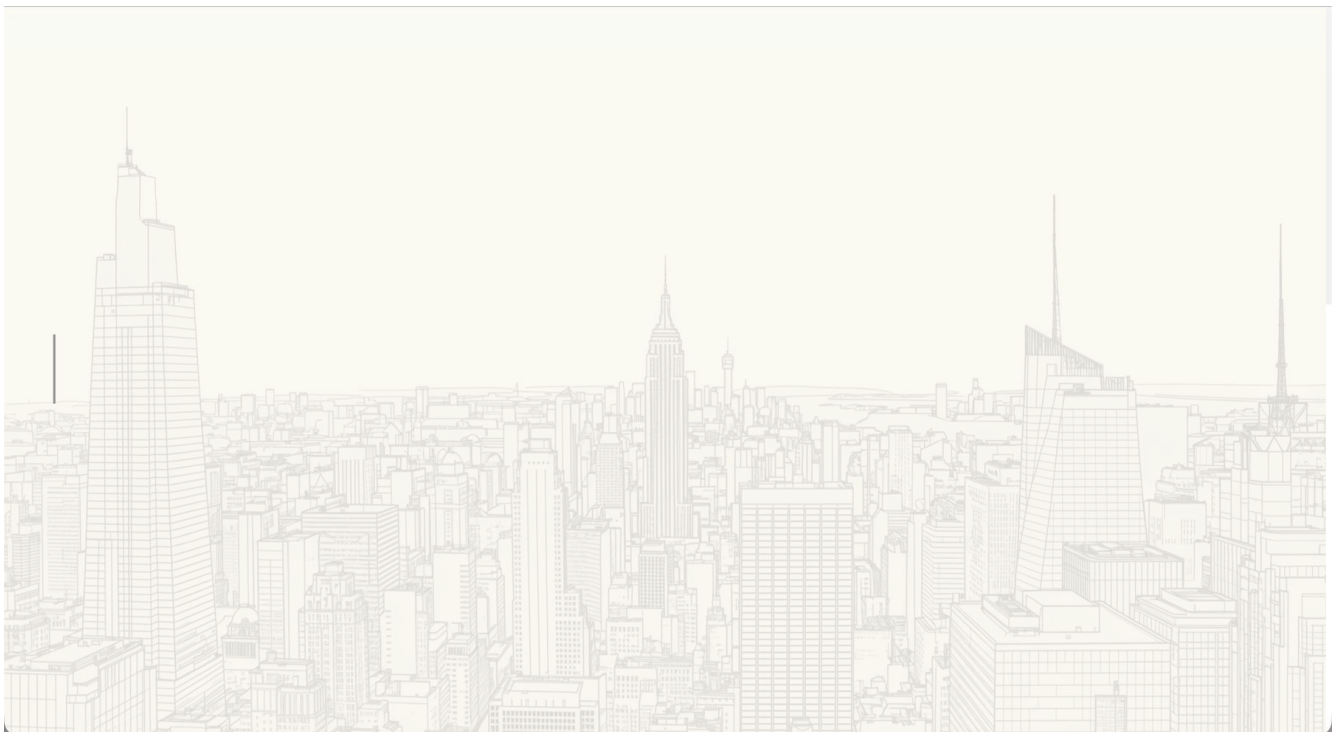
Mentioned as: "44-48 Union Square East"

[View Document Image](#)



Hennessy, *Walking Broadway*, 2020, p. 95

Quotes drawn from this page: 25 36



➡ Notable Buildings Around Union Square

A Union Square Savings Bank

20 Union Square East
1905-7 · HENRY BACON

This serious, well-proportioned, and understated treasure box was designed by the architect of the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. A handsome Corinthian portico faces Union Square, taking full advantage of the prominent site. The bank is now a theater.



95

B Tammany Hall

872.1 44 Union Square East
1928 · THOMPSON, HOLMES
& CONVERSE WITH CHARLES
BRADFORD MEYERS

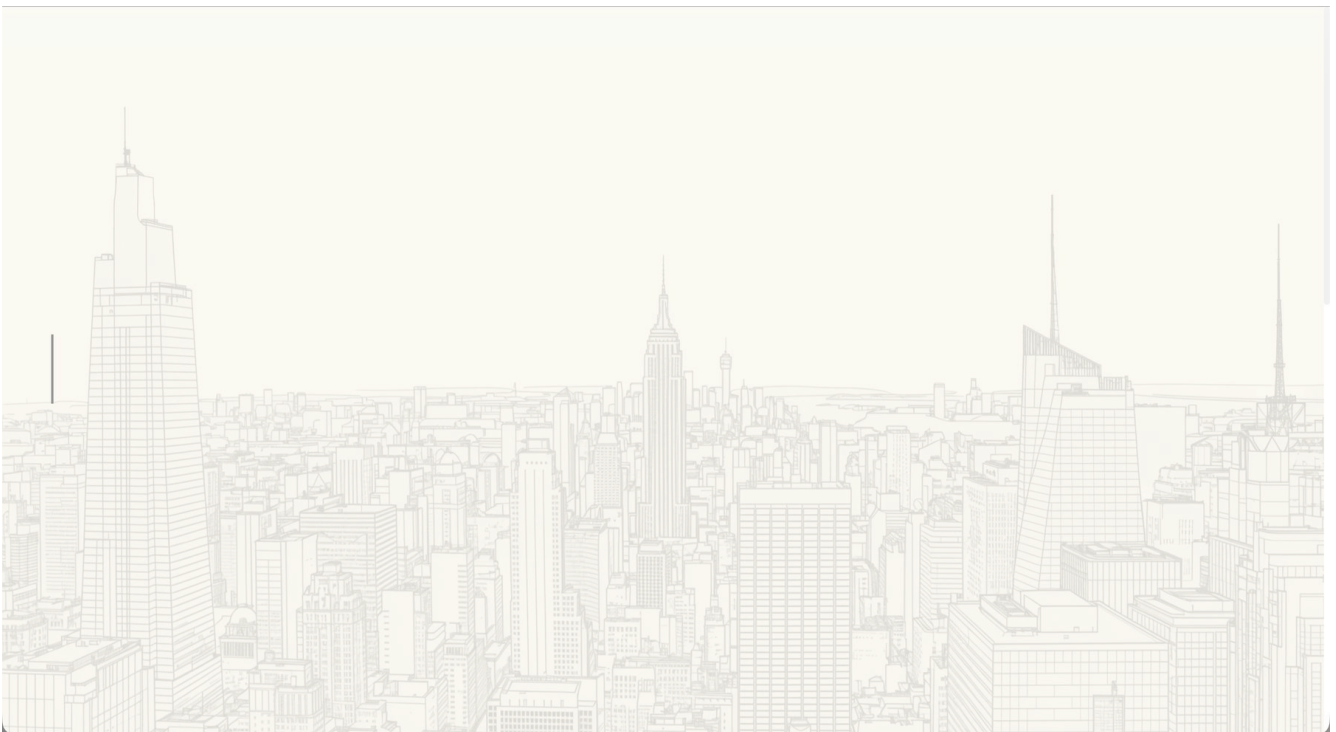
The Tammany Society, New York's Democratic political machine, virtually controlled the city during the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. At the peak of its power in the 1920s the society erected this clubhouse as its headquarters. The Union Square facade of the building including the first-floor balcony under the portico was deliberately modelled on that of New York's original Federal Hall on Wall Street (demolished 1812) where Washington was inaugurated as our nation's first President.

By the early 1930s the extent of the society's graft and corruption was widely recognized, and Tammany Mayor James J. Walker was forced to resign in 1932. A decade later the society sold its meeting



Jackson, *The Encyclopedia of New York*, 2010, p. 1278

Quotes drawn from this page: 34 35 37 38 39 40 41



leader—an unsalaried, extralegal commander of operations. They also appointed precinct captains whose job it was to help families in their neighborhoods during times of emergency, to find them work, to ease any problems they had with the law, and to make sure that they voted. Although ballot boxes were often stolen on election day, most victories by candidates allied with Tammany Hall were achieved through year-round attention to voters' needs and interests. Because the boss controlled nominations to elective offices, he had the last word in the discretionary appointments made by successful candidates for municipal office and used this power to reward loyal district leaders and supporters and to punish dissenters. Political integration of different ethnic groups varied widely. From mid-century Irish men dominated Tammany Hall and virtually monopolized district leaderships, remaining in power despite the changing population of their neighborhoods. Many Jews and Germans were admitted to the Tammany Society and were chosen to be state legislators, congressional representatives, and judges. The growing Italian population was largely ignored, and when the number of black voters in Harlem became significant, the neighborhood was subdivided and reallocated to adjacent districts with white majorities. Richard Croker, the boss from 1886 to 1902, retained Kelly's system but delegated decisions about patronage to local leaders more than Kelly had done.

After consolidation in 1898 the primacy of Tammany Hall depended on gaining the cooperation of Democrats in the outer boroughs. Those in Brooklyn opposed the organization until John McCooney became the leader of Kings County in 1909. He was a longtime friend of Croker's successor, Charles F. Murphy. One result of their collaboration was the nomination of two mayoral candidates from Brooklyn, William J. Gaynor in 1909 and John F. Hylan in 1921. In state government during these years politicians allied with Tammany Hall sponsored progressive labor laws and opposed Prohibition and censorship. Murphy promised the suffrage leader Carrie Chapman Catt that his organization would do nothing to prevent women from gaining the right to vote; women were later allowed to be district co-leaders but rarely had a voice in decisions. After Murphy's death the leaders decided to replace Mayor Hylan with James J. Walker, a member of Tammany Hall and a state senator. Their efforts were successful owing largely to the support of Edward J. Flynn, the leader in the Bronx, and to an effective campaign against Hylan by Governor Alfred E. Smith; after winning the Democratic primary they swept the November elections.

The machine received money and "kickbacks" from many sources: municipal suppliers, real estate interests, aspirants for judge-ships, and businessmen bidding for transit

franchises and pier leases. Legal fees and brokerage commissions were funneled to politically active lawyers and insurance agents, and generous campaign contributions were often made by such wealthy families as the Lehmans and the Strauses. Members of the inner circle profited from "honest graft," successful speculations based on confidential information about plans for schools and public works. As George Washington Plunkitt, a sachem who died a millionaire, declared, "I seen my opportunities and I took 'em."

Tammany Hall reached its zenith in 1928. Smith was a powerful and widely respected governor; Walker was an extraordinarily popular mayor; and George W. Olvany, a college graduate, was the boss. A new building was completed in 1929 on Union Square at 17th Street, and during this period even reformers had few criticisms of Tammany Hall. But the organization's fortunes soon changed. Investigations of civic corruption by Samuel Seabury led to Walker's resignation in 1932. John F. Curry, Olvany's successor, sought to block Franklin D. Roosevelt's presidential nomination, allowing Flynn, no longer an ally of Tammany Hall, to become the strongest link between the Democratic White House and the city. In 1933 Mayor John P. O'Brien, the incumbent and a loyalist chosen by Curry, finished last in a three-way mayoral election won by Fiorello H. La Guardia, who led a coalition opposed to Tammany Hall that remained in place for 12 years. Unable to meet mortgage payments, the sachems sold their building to Local 91 of the International Ladies' Garment Workers' Union in 1943. By the time the Democrats recaptured the mayoralty in 1945, Tammany Hall had virtually ceased to exist, although politicians bred in the organization continued to flourish into the 1950s and beyond.

Louis Eisenstein and Elliot Rosenberg, *A Stripe of Tammany's Tiger* (New York: R. Speller, 1966); Alfred Connable and Edward Silberfarb, *Tigers of Tammany: Nine Men Who Ran New York* (New York: Holt, Rinehart and Winston, 1967)

See also DEMOCRATIC PARTY.

Frank Vos

Tannenbaum, Frank (b Brod, Galicia, 4 March 1893; d New York City, 1 June 1969). Historian. After moving from a farm near Great Barrington, Massachusetts, to New York City in 1906 he joined the Industrial Workers of the World. In 1914 he was imprisoned for almost a year on Blackwell's Island for disturbing the peace by leading homeless men into churches to demand financial assistance and work. He received a PhD in economics in 1927 from the Brookings Institution and began teaching at Columbia in 1935, becoming a full professor of Latin American history in 1945. He founded and directed the interdisciplinary University Seminars at Columbia, which grew from five seminars in 1945

to more than 90 by 2008. Tannenbaum's published writings on Latin America were numerous. He also wrote on crime and prison reform, the labor movement, and race relations and edited the book *A Community of Scholars: The University Seminars at Columbia* (1965).

Joseph Maier and Richard W. Weatherhead, *Frank Tannenbaum: A Biographical Essay* (New York: Columbia University, 1974)

See also UNEMPLOYMENT MOVEMENTS.

Bernard Hirschhorn

tap dancing. The origins of tap dancing in New York City may be traced to the Five Points of the 1840s, where the African dances of blacks and the jigs and clog dances of the Irish exerted a reciprocal influence. Early tap dancers included the black minstrel Master Juba (William Henry Lane) and his white rival, Master John Diamond, who in 1844 faced each other in a competition at John Tryon's Amphitheater that Master Juba won. During the last third of the nineteenth century, black vaudevillians further refined the tap style, which was more rhythmic and looser than most other dances in vogue at the time.

The successful musical *Shuffle Along* (1921) by Flourney Miller, Aubrey Lyles, Noble Sissle, and Eubie Blake, which opened at Daly's Music Hall on 63rd Street, helped to establish tap dancing on the Broadway stage. In 1923 *Runnin' Wild* (also by Miller and Lyles) opened at the Colonial Theater and featured the Charleston, a fusion of tap and ballroom dancing that became immensely popular. Tap dancing was now important to the success of Broadway revues. The first great proponent of tap dancing was BILL "BOJANGLES" ROBINSON. After several years on the vaudeville circuit, he performed at clubs in Harlem and then appeared in *Blackbirds of 1928* by Lew Leslie and Will Vodery. He later danced in other Broadway shows and revues and eventually moved to Hollywood. Robinson's success inspired many tap dancers during the 1930s, among them Honi Coles, King Rastus Brown, Peg Leg Bates (who tapped on one leg), and such duos as Buck and Bubbles (Ford Lee Washington and John Washington Bubbles), Chuck and Chuckles (Charles Green and James Walker), and Stump and Stumpy (James Cross and Harold Cromer). The brothers Fayard and Harold Nicholas, who regularly performed their acrobatic tap dances at the Cotton Club and the Apollo Theater during the early 1930s, appeared on Broadway in Florenz Ziegfeld's *Follies* (1936) and in *Babes in Arms* (1937), by Richard Rodgers and Lorenz Hart.

Although tap remained essentially a black art form during the 1930s and 1940s, there were many important white tap dancers as well, including Fred Astaire, Ruby Keeler, and Gene Kelly. Clarence "Buddy" Bradley taught tap to white students and introduced creative

Village Voice, *Village Voice January 31st 1995*, 1995, p. 1

Quotes drawn from this page: 47 48 49 50 52



“LEARN FILM MAKING SUMMER WORKSHOPS AT
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ACADEMY DIRECT YOUR OWN SHORT FILMS IN OUR
HANDS-ON INTENSIVE WORKSHOPS USING 16MM
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CAMERA, SOUND AND EDITING IN A TOTAL
IMMERSION COURSE DESIGNED AND TAUGHT BY
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FORMERLY LOCATED AT TRIBECA FILM CENTER”

VILLAGE VOICE

- (1995) VILLAGE VOICE JANUARY 31ST 1995 · 1995
- P. 1

Mentioned as: "100 East 17th Street"

“Vita and Virginia: Vanessa Redgrave and Eileen Atkins star in, and Zoe Caldwell directs, this play based on the letters of Sackville West and Woolf. Union Square Theatre. 100 E 17th, 307-4100, through 2/26.”

VILLAGE VOICE

- (1995) VILLAGE VOICE JANUARY 31ST 1995 · 1995
- P. 1

Mentioned as: “100 East 17th Street”

“State of Siege, Sun: Vanessa Redgrave and Eileen Atkins host an evening of words and music to benefit the children of Sarajevo, 7. Also appearing will be Glenn Close, Stockard Channing, Mira Furlan, John Turturro, Christopher Reeve, Harvey Keitel, Simon Shaheen, Joseph Brodsky, Paul Auster, Ariel Dorfman, Susan Sontag, Tony Kushner, and Wendy Wasserstein. Union Square Theatre, 100 E 17th, 505-0700. \$”

VILLAGE VOICE

- (1995) VILLAGE VOICE JANUARY 31ST 1995 · 1995

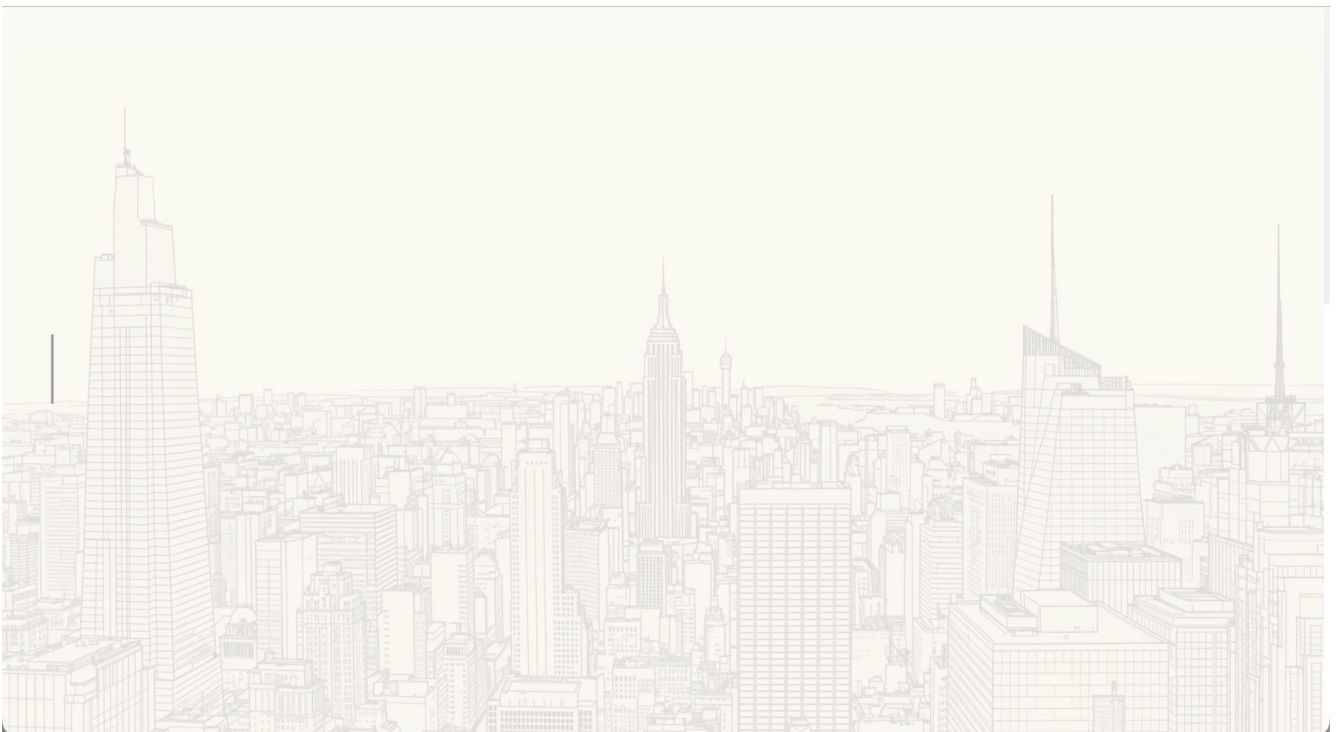
(1999) VILLAGE VOICE JANUARY 31ST 1999 1999

• P. 1

Mentioned as: "100 East 17th Street"

Lanigan-Schmidt, *Ghosts of New York City*, 2003, p. 64

Quotes drawn from this page: 54 55 59 60 61



season in 1916 utilizing the parlor floor of 139 MacDougal.

In 1917, they refurbished a four-story, pre-Victorian structure that was once a storehouse, stable and bottling works at #133 into a theatre seating 182 people. Among the plays first shown there included *The Emperor Jones*, which launched Paul Robeson's career and *The Hairy Ape*, both by O'Neill. The theatre was also home to Gertrude Stein and Edna St. Vincent Millay. Bette Davis appeared there early in her career.

Still a working theatre, long-time staffers swear it is haunted. They have noted odd sounds and a cold, opaque form that passes them on the steps.

Thimble Theatre

10 Fifth Avenue basement

The Thimble Theatre was located in the basement of the 1845 brownstone that still stands at 10 Fifth Avenue. Home to the ghost of the theatre's founder, Guido Bruno, a Greenwich Village eccentric usually identified by his flashy, ill-fitting plaid suits. Bruno is recognized as the originator of performance art and his theatre presented the U.S. debut of Strindberg's *Miss Julie*.

After Bruno's death, an occupant of the former theatre (which is now a basement apartment) recounted peculiar happenings, such as music playing from no visible source and objects sailing across the room.

The Union Square Theatre

100 East 17th Street



Union Square Theatre. Courtesy of Margaret Cotter.

Holmes, *100 New Yorker*, 2004, p. 37

Quotes drawn from this page: 56



then known as Newspaper Row, was once home to *The New York Herald*, *Times*, *Tribune*, *Sun*, and *World*. In Bly's day, it was the most important and most difficult to breach cluster of institutions in the country for an aspiring journalist.

.....

Roosevelt Island

In the East River from East 47th to East 96th Streets

On May 7, 1893, Bly's exposé of the insane asylum at Blackwell's Island (the former name of Roosevelt Island) appeared under her byline in *The World*. In her scheme to appear insane to the authorities and thereby to be admitted to the asylum, Bly had dressed in out-of-fashion clothes, let her hair become disheveled, and perfected a far-away look with which she wandered the streets. Having set the stage, she checked into Irene Stenard's Temporary Home for Women at 84 Second Avenue.

Pouncing on the romantic mystery (possibly fueled by Pulitzer himself), other newspapers asked their readers to help identify the young, beautiful, apparently affluent amnesiac by publishing her photo under headlines such as: "Who is this Insane Girl?" (*The Sun*) and "Mysterious Waif with the Wild Hunted Look in Her Eyes" (*The New York Times*). Though the warden at the Lunatic Asylum insisted, after the fact, that he had been suspicious all along, three doctors at Bellevue diagnosed Bly as "undoubtedly insane." She was ferried across the East River to Blackwell's Island where she spent ten days before Pulitzer sprung her from the nightmarish place.

The Octagon Tower, formerly the central structure of the Lunatic Asylum, is extant and protected as a historic site on Roosevelt Island. The Asylum, designed in 1839, was New York's first. Charles Dickens toured the hospital in 1841 during his visit to New York; he noted with familiar sadness the "long, listless, madhouse air."

.....

New York Union Square Theatre

100 East 17th Street, between Park Avenue and Irving Place
tel. (212) 505-0700

Bly delivered a series of lectures here about her record-breaking trip around the globe. As happened with many star reporters of the era, Bly's editors, once overshadowed, stopped promoting her. Bly left *The World*, feeling she was underpaid and underappreciated. She was forced to return to the staff after a failed stint as a novelist.

.....

Site of The Tombs

100 Centre Street, between Worth and Leonard Streets

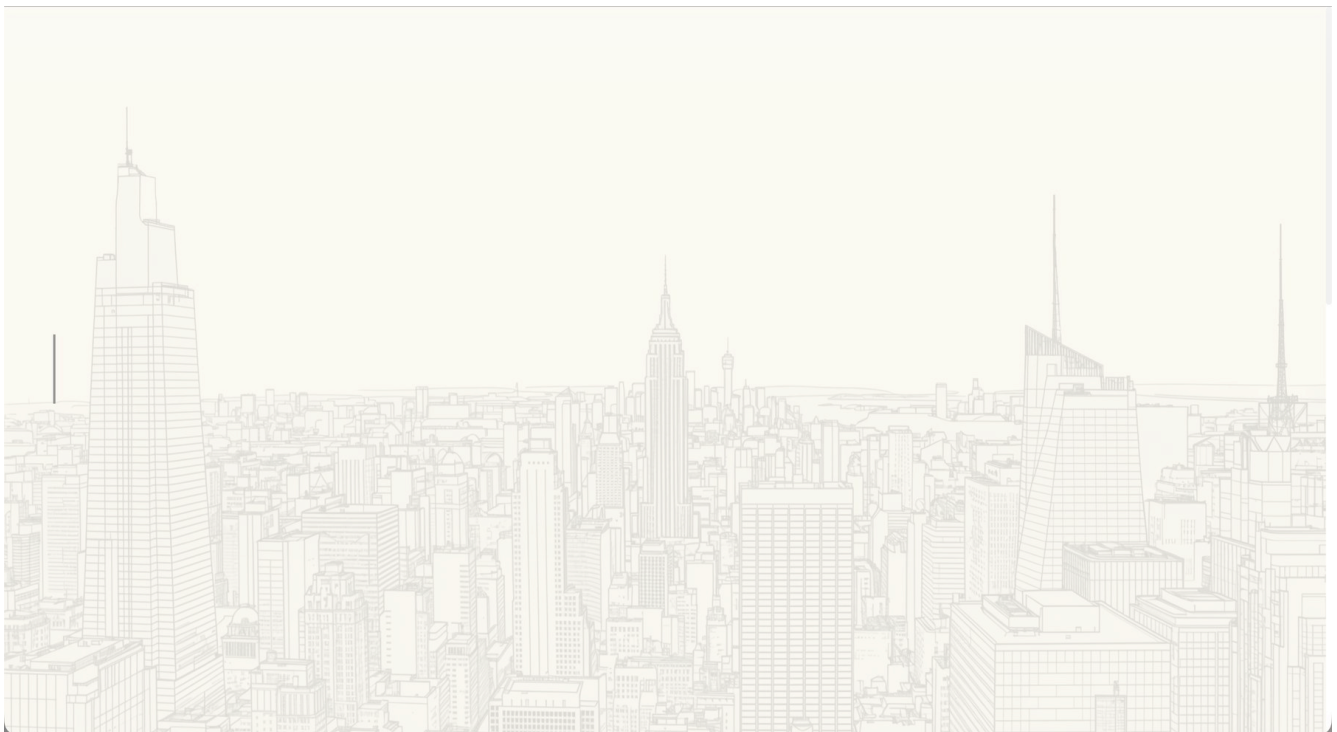
167

This site, now occupied by the Criminal Courts Building, once held the city's massive, nineteenth-century prison complex. The complex had been styled after an Egyptian

mausoleum and was known popularly as "the Tombs." Though the building that inspired the nickname is long gone, the city's central detention center is still called "the Tombs." Bly interviewed anarchist Emma Goldman here in 1893, after Goldman was imprisoned for allegedly inciting the poor to take bread "by force." Hers was the first interview with the notorious Goldman in the mainstream press. In her article published in *The World*, Bly addressed her readers: "You see her in your mind a great raw-boned creature, with short hair and bloomers, a red flag in one hand, a burning torch in the other; both feet constantly off of the ground and 'murder!' continually upon her lips." Bly encountered instead a petite woman of twenty-five with "very expressive blue-gray eyes" and a gentle

Wilson, *New York in Literature*, 1947, p. 128

Quotes drawn from this page: 57 58



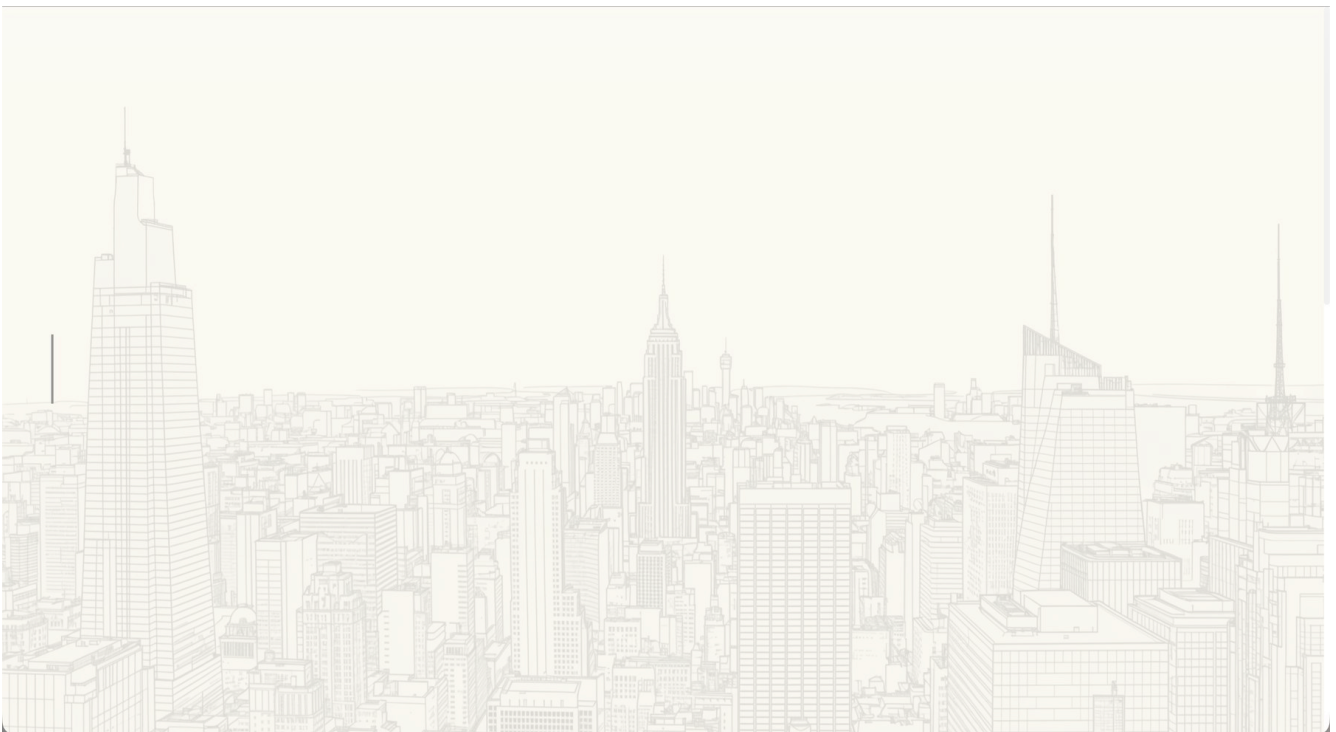
That sturdy descendant of the Knickerbockers, Gulian C. Verplanck, died at 12 East Sixteenth Street, and adjoining the College of St. Francis Xavier, less than a block distant, is the brownstone house which was the home of Bryant in the "white winter of his age." Again at 115 East Sixteenth Street Howells lodged for a time in 1900 and 1901. "I see a great deal of Mark Twain nowadays," he wrote his sister from this address, "and we have good times denouncing everything. We are old fellows, and it is pleasant to find the world so much worse than it was when we were young." And William S. Rainsford's home was at 209 East Sixteenth Street in the years when he was finding zest and profit in the labors later recorded in the *Story of a Varied Life*. George E. Woodberry, when a professor at Columbia, had bachelor apartments at 5 East Seventeenth Street. This was on the morrow of the writing and publication of the life of Poe for which he is now best remembered, and which summed up that poet's shortcomings with a severity still disputed by students of a troubled career. A three-story structure of red brick at 66 East Seventeenth Street was for a number of years the home of Edgar, nephew of Washington Irving, and an occasional sojourn of the gentle humorist when in old age he came from Sunnyside for a few days' visit to the city; and the last home of Jeannette L. Gilder, long editor of the *Critic* and an arresting, if some times amusing, figure in the literary life of the town a generation ago, was at 100 East Seventeenth Street.

At 23 Irving Place in the middle years of the last century dwelt Isaac C. Pray, brother of the gifted Malvina Pray and himself an author, actor and playwright of parts, who there wrote a biography of the elder Bennett, founder of the *Herald*, and welcomed Charles Dickens as friend and guest when in 1842 the latter visited America for the first time. Eleven numbers northward on the same side of Irving Place, still stands an old-fashioned house which was the last home of Caroline Matilda Kirkland, whose sketches of Western life, published under the pen name of Mary Clevers, gave her a secure if modest place in the literary circles of her period. At 57 Irving Place was long the home of William Conant Church, editor of the *Army and Navy Journal*, who there wrote his life of Ericsson and other books. Two doors removed on the same side of the way William Sidney

Porter had his lodgings during his most productive years as an author, finding in the neighborhood the background for some of his most diverting tales.

Reynolds, *Monuments and Masterpieces*, 1988, p. 187

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Union Square, a park that has meant independence and freedom of speech for generations. There, especially during the 1930s, people came to speak their minds without fear of assault or arrest. Appropriately, the statues of Washington, Lincoln, Lafayette, and most recently Gandhi, share axes with the Independence Flagstaff. And it is fitting, as one stands to read the flagstaff's historic friezes with their idealized, almost life-size figures of Indians, pioneer families, horses, and buffaloes, portraying the American struggle for independence, that another liberty cap—across the street in the pediment of the old Tammany meeting place at 100 East Seventeenth Street—is eminently visible as it oversees the park and the Charles F. Murphy Monument.

Stone as Symbol

Plaques set into great boulders and outcroppings of Manhattan schist, the stone that is millions of years old upon which Manhattan is built, have a special character because of the meaning of stone. The solidity, integrity, and permanence of stone have been recognized from early times as the antithesis of biological things, which are subject to laws of change, decay, and death. Ancient cultures worshiped stones as possessing magic powers and as dwelling places of the gods. They treated certain stones with special respect. In the book of Genesis, the stone Jacob took from a sacred shrine and used as a pillow when he dreamed of the prophetic stairway between God and man, he interpreted as the abode of God and set up as a memorial stone. Alchemists thought the philosopher's stone contained the power to transform baser metals into gold.

Megaliths

Monumental stones were used by ancient cultures to mark sacred places and burial sites. Historians call these massive markers megaliths, which means "great stones," and they date from as early as 3000 B.C. If they are dressed—that is, cut and prepared—they are called monoliths. Great boulders in their primitive and natural state, then, are associated with people's earliest attempts to deal with notions of death. These associations continue even into modern times. Following World War II, for example, rough-hewn natural boulders had widespread appeal as commemorative markers, and they are found throughout the city in all boroughs bearing

